

VOLCANOES

A volcano is a vent in the Earth's surface through which molten rock and hot gases escape. Volcanoes can lie dormant for many years before erupting suddenly, causing tremendous destruction as the poisonous gases are discharged and lava (molten rock) flows out. The word volcano comes from an island in the Mediterranean that the Romans called Volcano. This volcanic island had a crater that blew out smokelike vapor, making the Romans believe that it was the home of Vulcan, their god of fire.



A mud slide in Nicaragua that killed over 1,000 people.



Mount Ruapehu in New Zealand lights up the night sky as it erupts.

LANDSLIDES

When a hillside collapses, it is called a landslide. It can be both a natural or a man-made disaster.

It can be caused by the ground becoming saturated with rain water and giving way, earthquakes, or volcanic eruptions, but can also be triggered by human activity weakening the hillside through deforestation, machinery vibration, or the weight of buildings.

TORNADOES

Tornadoes, sometimes called twisters, are powerful whirling winds, accompanied by funnel-shaped clouds. The winds blow clockwise north of the equator and counterclockwise south of the equator. It is thought that they form when cold polar air meets warm tropical air. These winds have tremendous power and can rip up everything in their path, including whole buildings. Tornadoes are most common in Australia and the Midwest and the South, US.



A tornado approaches a corn field in Kansas.



TSUNAMIS

A tsunami is a huge wave created by an underwater earthquake, or by a volcanic eruption at or below sea level. Shockwaves from the earthquake create a tsunami that can travel at more than 435 mph (700 km/h). The tsunami gains height as it nears land. As the wave breaks, it causes devastation in low-lying coastal areas.

MAJOR INTERNATIONAL AID ORGANIZATIONS

CARE

One of the world's largest private international relief and development organizations, it works in over 60 countries around the world. CARE reaches out to people whose lives are devastated by humanitarian emergencies, or who are struggling each day in poor communities to improve their lives.

CARITIS INTERNATIONALIS

A worldwide network of Catholic relief and development organizations, such as CAFOD in the United Kingdom, that spreads

solidarity and social justice, without regard to creed, race, or gender.

MEDECINS SANS FRONTIERS (DOCTORS WITHOUT BORDERS)

Medecins Sans Frontiers (MSF) is an international humanitarian aid organization that provides emergency medical assistance to populations in danger in more than 80 countries. It provides medical aid wherever it is needed, regardless of race, religion, politics, or sex, and also raises awareness of the plight of the people in the developing world.

MUSLIM AID

Founded in 1985, it tries to improve the lives of people in the 44 poorest countries in the world through development programs such as the provision of clean water, health care, shelter, and education.

OXFAM INTERNATIONAL

Working for an end to the waste and injustice of poverty, both in long-term development work and times of urgent need. A group of independent organizations that work together to achieve greater impact by collective efforts.

SAVE THE CHILDREN

Founded in the United Kingdom in 1919 by Eglantyne Jebb, Save the Children works to improve the lives of children who are faced with poverty, violence, and injustice around the world.

UNITED NATIONS

CHILDREN'S FUND (UNICEF) Founded in 1946, UNICEF works for the protection of children's rights, to help them meet their basic needs, and to expand their opportunities so that they can reach their full potential.